



Unit 5 — Media and Public Opinion

Track E • Klasse 13 • Niveau E (Basisfach / Leistungsfach) • Abitur year

Learning objectives

- *I can read short texts on platform algorithms and public opinion (Tufekci, Wu) and identify the writer's central causal claim.*
- *I can use vocabulary of platform-media analysis (algorithmic amplification, attention rent, recommendation system, network effect, platform governance).*
- *I can write a 450-word media-analysis essay sustaining a complex causal argument.*

Lead-in

The class read short extracts from Zeynep Tufekci's *Twitter and Tear Gas* (2017) and Tim Wu's *The Attention Merchants* (2016). Mr. Yilmaz framed the question: *what is the difference between public opinion and aggregated platform behaviour?* The class noticed quickly that the answer is not *nothing* and not *everything*.

Vocabulary

- algorithmic amplification
- attention rent
- recommendation system
- network effect
- platform governance
- content moderation
- attention economy
- asymmetric visibility
- the visible majority
- micro-targeting

Key points

- *Wu (2016)*: The history of mass media is the history of *attention merchants* — actors whose business model is the harvest, packaging, and resale of attention. Platforms inherit and intensify this model.

Practise

- Match: algorithmic amplification → ranking-driven visibility; attention rent → the price of your attention; the visible majority → not the same as the actual majority.
- T or F: platforms inherit the attention-merchant model; algorithmic amplification reflects underlying public opinion 1:1.
- Build 4 sentences applying platform-media vocabulary to a recent online controversy.

Your turn

Media-analysis essay, 450 words. Argue a complex causal claim about platforms and public opinion. Use 6 platform-media terms + 7 academic discourse markers + 2 cleft structures + 2 integrated quotes + 1 hedge.

Reflect

- I can identify the writer's central causal claim in a platform-media text.
- I can use 6+ platform-media terms.
- I can write a 450-word media-analysis essay with a complex causal argument.